Sama Ahmed

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Education

California State University, Fullerton — Fullerton, CA
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Cum Laude — May 2026

Experience

User Experience Researcher (Incoming) | *LPL Financial* — Jul. 2026 – Present

Web Design Intern | *Titan Radio* — Jan. 2026 – May 2026

- Redesigned key pages (Meet Our DJs, The Feed), increasing user engagement and improving content discoverability for a student media platform with **6K+** Instagram followers
- Built a semester archive and updated blog/DJ pages to improve content organization and access to past and current staff

User Experience Research Intern | *LPL Financial* — Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Conducted heuristic evaluations identifying **10+** issues that shaped the product roadmap and development cycles
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to present insights, influencing a platform used by **30,000+** advisors
- Built persona guides and streamlined documentation to increase project velocity for the cross-functional UX team

Supplemental Instruction Leader | *CSU Fullerton* — Aug. 2024 – May 2025

- Facilitated bi-weekly Calculus I sessions, improving average student grades by **10%** through targeted reinforcement
- Designed interactive group activities to simplify complex technical topics and foster a collaborative environment

IT Student Assistant | *CSU Fullerton* — Aug. 2023 – Jun. 2026

- Provided technical support to faculty and staff by troubleshooting hardware/software and configuring workstations
- Resolved **500+** ServiceNow tickets, reducing response times and increasing faculty satisfaction with IT services

Project

Fliq. | *SvelteKit, Tailwind, Gemini NanoBanana, Supabase, Render*

- Built a real-time collaborative photo booth web app enabling users to take shared photo-strip experiences remotely
- Integrated Supabase for real-time session sync and Gemini NanoBanana API for AI-generated backgrounds

Leadership

Campus Leader | *Figma* — Jan. 2026 – May 2026

- Facilitated workshops for **100+** students, introducing UI/UX prototyping best practices and collaborative design tools
- Coordinated tabling events, launch parties, and work sessions to support participation in the FigBuild designathon

Web Development Team Lead | *FullyBeyond* — May 2024 – Nov. 2024

- Managed a 5-person engineering team to build the FullyBeyond designathon platform using SvelteKit and TailwindCSS
- Partnered with 11 cross-functional organizers to launch the event, driving engagement for **100+** student participants

Webmaster, Board Member | *Association for Computing Machinery at CSUF* — Jan. 2024 – Dec. 2025

- Managed acmcsuf.com by reviewing **40+** PRs and optimizing documentation for **70+** open-source contributors
- Led workshops for **30+** students on SvelteKit and front-end design to foster hands-on open-source collaboration
- Mentored students through career sessions focused on resume building, technical interviews, and portfolio optimization

Co-Director, UI/UX Designer | *FullyHacks* — Sep. 2023 – Apr. 2026

- Co-designed the user interface for FullyHacks 2024, ensuring a seamless experience for **400+** applicants and **10** sponsors
- Led **50+** organizers across cross-functional teams to drive a **35%** year-over-year increase in project submissions for 2025
- Developed high-fidelity UI/UX assets and marketing visuals for the 2026 event cycle as part of the Design Team

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** Python, SQL, JavaScript, Swift, C/C++, HTML/CSS
- **Frameworks:** SvelteKit, React, Flask, Tailwind, Bootstrap, SwiftUI, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Git, Linux